15.21 Postpartum Depression*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I cry all the time and feel I am a bad mother." **Objective** • Tearful and withdrawn 3 weeks after birth • High depression screening score • Neglects her own care	**ACTUAL** Maladaptive coping related to postpartum mood changes and demands of infant care as evidenced by tearfulness, withdrawal and negative self-statements.	• Talks about her feelings and accepts treatment and support.	• Screen with a validated tool such as the Edinburgh Postnatal Depression Scale. • Ask directly about thoughts of harming herself or the baby; refer urgently if present. • Refer to mental health services. • Involve the family in helping with the baby.	• Met when she accepts support and treatment.
Subjective • "I cannot sleep even when the baby sleeps." **Objective** • Insomnia • Exhausted	**ACTUAL** Ineffective sleep pattern related to low mood and anxiety as evidenced by inability to sleep.	• Sleeps better within 1 week.	• Arrange family help with night feeds. • Encourage rest when the baby sleeps. • Give prescribed medication if ordered.	• Achieved as sleep improves.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Low mood • Little social support	**RISK** Risk for impaired parenting behaviors as evidenced by risk factors: maternal depression and insufficient social support.	• The baby receives safe, adequate care.	• Watch how mother and baby interact. • Arrange home visits. • Draw in family and community support.	• Outcome reached when the baby is cared for safely.

*References for this care plan: [15], [31], [35], [47], [65]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.